

AMERICA UNDER ATTACK: 16 pages of coverage

TERROR



The Associated Press

Pedestrians flee the area of the World Trade Center as the center's south tower crashes following a terrorist attack. Yesterday's events were probably the worst act of terrorism in history.

Thousands die in plane attacks on twin towers and Pentagon

THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

In the most devastating terrorist onslaught ever waged against the United States, knife-wielding hijackers crashed two airliners into the World Trade Center yesterday, toppling its twin 110-story towers. Two other planes were commandeered; one slammed into the Pentagon and another crashed outside Pittsburgh.

Establishing the U.S. death toll could take weeks. The four airliners had 266 people aboard and there were no known survivors. In New York City, a firefighters union official said he feared an estimated 200 firefighters had died in rescue efforts. Dozens of police officers were believed missing.

No one took responsibility for the attacks, but federal authorities identified Osama bin Laden as the prime suspect.

Last night in his first prime-time Oval Office address, President Bush mourned the deaths of thousands of Americans and vowed to avenge their killings. "Today, our nation saw evil," he said.

The attacks moved the nation toward a level of safety it had never seen before.

For the first time, the nation's aviation system was completely shut down as officials considered the frightening flaws that had been exposed in security procedures. Financial markets were closed, too.

Evacuations were ordered at the tallest skyscrapers in several cities. And high-profile tourist attractions — Walt Disney World, Mount Rushmore, Seattle's Space Needle — were closed.

Said Adm. Robert Natter, commander of the U.S. Atlantic Fleet: "We have been attacked like we haven't since Pearl Harbor." □

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On the Web

■ For the most up-to-date news on the attacks and how they are affecting the Rochester area, go online to:
DemocratandChronicle.com

■ To comment on yesterday's events, click on "bulletin boards" at:
DemocratandChronicle.com

News tips

■ Call the Metro desk at 258-2252 or 258-2214.